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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Political Science

Politics of Planned Development

Unit X · Bombay Plan, First vs Second FYP, Agrarian Debates, Green Revolution & Operation Flood · CUET UG 2027 Mastery

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Syllabus Alignment & Chapter Architecture

Sub-Topic Domain	Official NTA CUET UG Unit X Syllabus Scope	High-Frequency Cognitive Skills Tested
Ideas of Development	Political contestation on development; capitalist vs socialist models; Left vs Right economic orientations; Bombay Plan (1944); Planning Commission (March 1950, extra-constitutional body, PM as ex-officio chairman); replacement by NITI Aayog (1 Jan 2015).	Distinguishing developmental models; analyzing consensus on state planning; contrasting Planning Commission with NITI Aayog.
The Early Five-Year Plans	First Five-Year Plan (1951–56): K.N. Raj, agriculture, irrigation, Bhakra Nangal Dam, "hasten slowly", national savings; Second Five-Year Plan (1956–61): P.C. Mahalanobis, heavy industrialization, steel plants (Bhilai, Rourkela, Durgapur), capital goods, import tariffs.	Contrasting First vs Second Plan strategies; evaluating Mahalanobis model; analyzing capital allocation priorities.
Major Controversies in Planning	Agriculture vs Industry debate; J.C. Kumarappa's 'Economy of Permanence' (Gandhian rural decentralization); Chaudhary Charan Singh (agrarian focus vs urban industrial bias); Public vs Private sector (Mixed economy, commanding heights vs License-Permit Raj).	Evaluating rural-urban developmental trade-offs; analyzing Gandhian ecological critique; assessing mixed-economy outcomes.
Land Reforms & Structural Limits	Abolition of Zamindari system (successful); tenancy security legislation; land ceiling acts and benami land transfers; fragmentation of agricultural holdings; political dominance of rural landed gentry.	Deconstructing land reform successes vs failures; assessing structural obstacles to redistributive social justice.
Food Crisis & The Green Revolution	1960s drought and food shortages; Bihar famine (1965–67); US PL-480 food import dependence ("ship-to-mouth"); Plan Holidays (1966–69); Green Revolution: M.S. Swaminathan, Norman Borlaug, HYV seeds, fertilizers, tubewells, MSP; concentration in Punjab, Haryana, Western UP; rise of 'kulak' middle peasantry.	Tracing food crisis geopolitics; evaluating Green Revolution socio-economic impacts; diagnosing regional and class disparities.
The White Revolution (Operation Flood)	Dr. Verghese Kurien ("Milkman of India"); National Dairy Development Board (NDDB, 1970); Amul cooperative dairy model in Anand, Gujarat; rural empowerment and poverty alleviation.	Analyzing cooperative dairy architecture; evaluating rural empowerment mechanisms; assessing cooperative vs corporate agribusiness.

CUET HIGH-SCORING INSIGHT & KEY COGNITIVE TRAPS

Theme 10 requires exact recall of plan architects, key dates, controversies, and agricultural revolutions:

1. **Planning Commission vs NITI Aayog:**

- **Planning Commission:** Established in **March 1950** via Cabinet Resolution (extra-constitutional, non-statutory body).
- **NITI Aayog:** Established on **1 January 2015** under Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

2. **First vs Second Five-Year Plan Comparison:**
   - **First Plan (1951–1956):** Architect: **K.N. Raj**; Priority: **Agriculture & Irrigation** (Bhakra Nangal); Mantra: **"Hasten slowly"**.
   - **Second Plan (1956–1961):** Architect: **P.C. Mahalanobis**; Priority: **Heavy Industry & Steel** (Bhilai, Rourkela, Durgapur); High tariffs.
   - **Plan Holidays: 1966–1969** (three annual plans) following wars and severe droughts.
3. **Key Developmental Thinkers:**
   - **Bombay Plan (1944):** Signed by big industrialists demanding state capital investments in heavy industry.
   - **J.C. Kumarappa:** Gandhian economist; authored **Economy of Permanence**; proposed rural cottage industrialization.
   - **Chaudhary Charan Singh:** Advocated agriculture and rural peasantry over urban industrial planning.
4. **Green vs White Revolution Architects:**
   - **Green Revolution: Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** (Mexican dwarf wheat, HYV seeds, Punjab/Haryana/Western UP).
   - **White Revolution (Operation Flood, 1970): Dr. Verghese Kurien** (Amul, Anand, Gujarat, NDDB).

1. Ideas of Development and Political Contestation

At the dawn of independence, the defining political debate in India revolved around the fundamental meaning, trajectory, and ideological model of "development":

The Clash of Competing Developmental Visions

In the post-World War II global order, modernization and development were synonymous with the Western experience of industrialization, urban growth, and modern science:

- **The Capitalist / Western Model:** Advocated free-market capitalism, private corporate ownership of industrial assets, minimal state regulation, and integration with the global capitalist economy (the model championed by the United States and Western Europe).
- **The Socialist / Soviet Model:** Advocated state ownership of industrial enterprises, elimination of private landlordism, collectivization or state control of agriculture, and comprehensive centralized economic planning (the model of the Soviet Union).
- **The Gandhian Alternative:** Advocated a decentralized, rural-centered economy focusing on village self-sufficiency, Khadi cottage industries, moral restraint against consumerism, and ecological harmony, articulated forcefully by thinkers like **J.C. Kumarappa**.

The Left vs Right Political Cleavages

- **The Left:** Refers to those political forces (Socialists, Communists) that favor the poor and downtrodden sections, advocating government redistributive policies, nationalization of industries, and aggressive land reforms.

- **The Right:** Refers to those political forces (Swatantra Party, conservative business lobbies) that believe free competition and market mechanisms drive economic efficiency, opposing heavy state taxation and planning.

The Historic Consensus: The Bombay Plan (1944)

A prevalent historical myth assumes that private capitalists always oppose state-led economic planning. In India, big business championed state intervention:

- In **1944**, a prominent group of India's foremost industrial tycoons—including **J.R.D. Tata, G.D. Birla, Sir Purshotamdas Thakurdas, Kasturbhai Lalbhai**, and **John Mathai**—assembled in Bombay to draft a joint proposal titled **A Brief Memorandum Outlining a Plan of Economic Development for India**, popularly known as the **Bombay Plan**.
- The industrialists recognized that private capital lacked the colossal resources required to build heavy capital-goods industries, ports, railways, and electrical power grids. They explicitly demanded that the state make massive public investments in heavy industrial infrastructure.

Setting Up the Planning Commission (March 1950)

- In **March 1950**, the Government of India established the **Planning Commission** via an executive cabinet resolution.
- It was an **extra-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body**, with the **Prime Minister serving as its ex-officio Chairman**.
- On **1 January 2015**, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's administration dissolved the 65-year-old Planning Commission, replacing it with the **NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India) to foster "cooperative federalism."

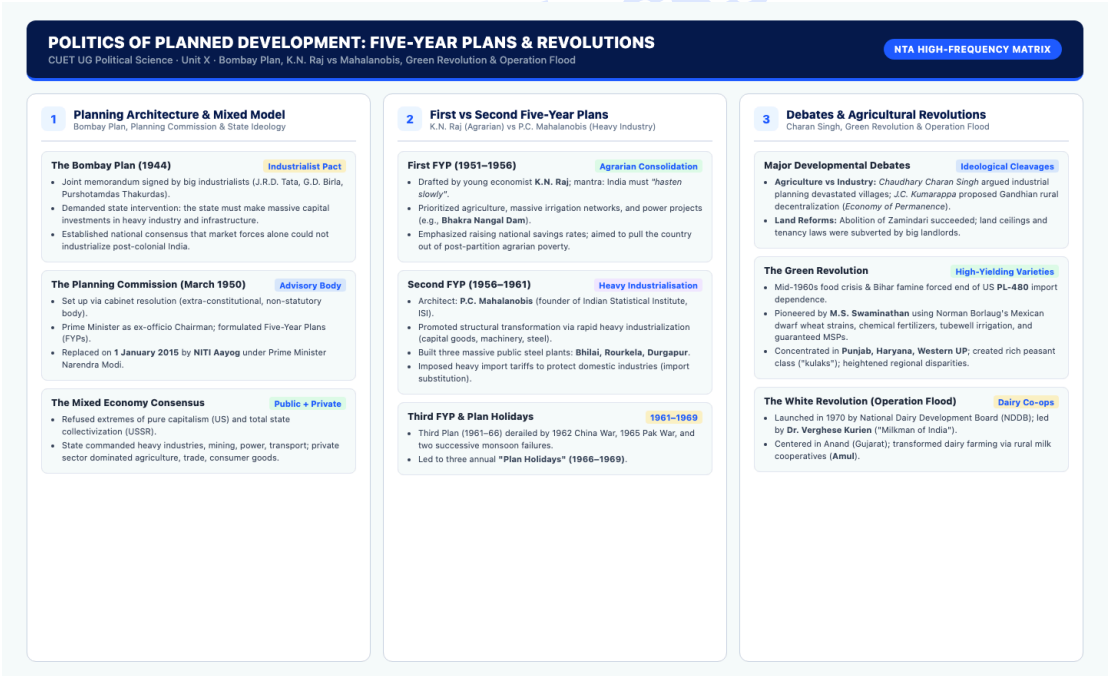


Figure 1: Figure 1 — Planned Development Architectural Matrix: Bombay Plan, First vs Second Five-Year Plans comparison, key developmental debates, and agricultural revolutions.

2. The Early Five-Year Plans: Agrarian Caution vs Heavy Industry

Independent India adopted the Soviet-inspired mechanism of Five-Year Plans (FYPs) to guide economic growth and resource allocation:

The First Five-Year Plan (1951–1956): "Hasten Slowly"

- **The Intellectual Architect:** Drafted under the leadership of a brilliant young economist, **K.N. Raj**, who argued that India must **"hasten slowly"** during its first two decades to avoid catastrophic inflation.
- **Core Priority: Agriculture & Irrigation:** Focused primarily on the agrarian sector to overcome the severe food shortages and cotton/jute raw material crises caused by the partition of the subcontinent.
- **Monumental Investments:** Poured colossal state resources into massive multipurpose river valley projects, most notably the **Bhakra Nangal Dam** in Punjab and the **Hirakud Dam** on the Mahanadi in Odisha.
- **Raising National Savings:** The plan emphasized that poverty could be dismantled only if the rate of national domestic savings rose steadily. Between 1951 and 1956, domestic savings rose significantly, laying the financial foundation for future industrialization.

The Second Five-Year Plan (1956–1961): The Industrial Big Push

- **The Intellectual Architect:** Authored by the legendary statistician **Prof. Prasanta Chandra Mahalanobis**, founder of the **Indian Statistical Institute (ISI)** in Kolkata.
- **The 1955 Avadi Congress Resolution:** At its Avadi session in 1955, the Indian National Congress formally declared its commitment to establishing a **"socialistic pattern of society"**.
- **The Mahalanobis Heavy Industrialization Strategy:**
  - Argued that long-term economic independence required producing "machines to make machines" (capital goods), rather than importing foreign technology.
  - Poured public capital into heavy engineering, mining, chemicals, locomotives, and electrical generation.
  - Built three massive public-sector steel plants with foreign collaboration: **Bhilai** (with Soviet assistance in MP/Chhattisgarh), **Rourkela** (with West German assistance in Odisha), and **Durgapur** (with British assistance in West Bengal).
  - **Protectionist Tariff Walls:** Imposed prohibitive import tariffs and quotas on manufactured consumer goods to protect infant domestic private and public industries from foreign competition.
- **The Third Plan & Plan Holidays:** The Third Plan (1961–1966) attempted to balance agriculture and heavy industry, but was severely disrupted by the 1962 Sino-Indian War, the 1965 Indo-Pakistani War, and consecutive catastrophic monsoon failures. This triggered acute foreign exchange exhaustion, forcing the government to declare three annual **"Plan Holidays" (1966–1969)** before resuming the Fourth Plan in 1969.

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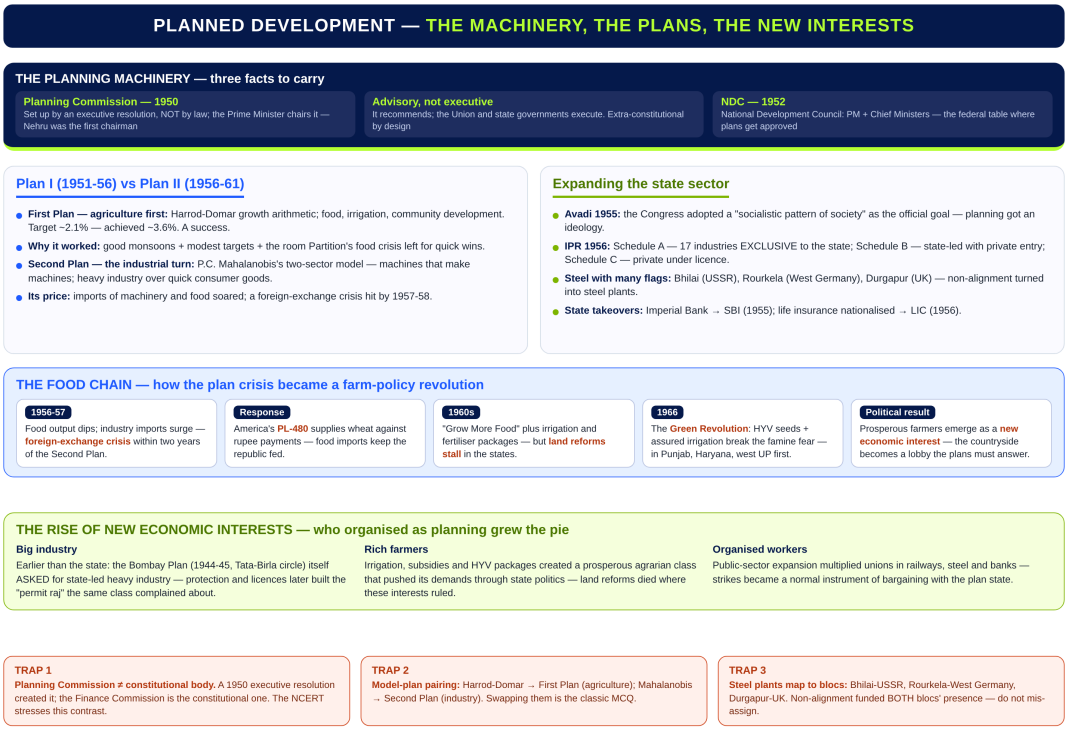


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Thematic Chronology & Planning Engine Architecture: GDP trajectories, public vs private sectoral shares, food grain production trends, and the Green Revolution arc.

3. Major Controversies: Ideological and Structural Cleavages

The trajectory of state planning ignited intense ideological debates that reshaped Indian politics:

Agriculture vs Industry: Rural vs Urban Bias

- **Chaudhary Charan Singh's Critique:**
  - Peasant leader and former Congress minister Chaudhary Charan Singh argued that the Mahalanobis strategy exhibited a profound urban-industrial bias, siphoning scarce public resources into heavy industries while starving agriculture and village craftspeople.
  - He argued that industrial planning caused rural impoverishment, demanding that planning place agriculture, small-scale rural credit, and peasant welfare at the absolute center of national development.
- **J.C. Kumarappa and the 'Economy of Permanence':**
  - Gandhian economist **J.C. Kumarappa** (author of **Economy of Permanence**) presented an alternative developmental blueprint.
  - He warned that Western-style industrialization exploited nature, displaced labor, and concentrated wealth in urban monopolies, advocating instead for rural decentralization, natural organic farming, and village cottage industries.

Public vs Private Sector: The "Mixed Economy" Consensus

India opted for a **Mixed Economy**, combining elements of state capitalism and private enterprise:

- **Critique from the Left:** Socialists argued that the state did not do enough: it invested public money into unprofitable, high-risk infrastructure (steel, dams, transport) merely to create a subsidized playground for private corporate tycoons, while failing to nationalize private consumer industries or provide universal healthcare and education.

- **Critique from the Right:** The **Swatantra Party** and private business lobbies argued that the state did too much: it created an oppressive, corrupt, bureaucratic **"License-Permit-Quota Raj"** that strangled private entrepreneurial initiative, banned foreign investment, and bred inefficiency in loss-making public enterprises.

4. Land Reforms: Achievements and Structural Failures

In the agrarian domain, the independent Indian state initiated legislative land reforms to dismantle centuries of feudal exploitation:

The Abolition of the Zamindari System

- **The Unprecedented Triumph:** The most significant and universally successful land reform measure was the legal **abolition of the colonial Zamindari system**.
- **Impact:** Stripped hereditary absentee landlords of vast feudal estates, releasing millions of tenant cultivators from direct feudal subjugation and transferring land ownership to actual cultivators. It brought peasants into direct contact with the state and deprived feudal princes and zamindars of their traditional rural political dominance.

Tenancy Reforms, Land Ceilings and Structural Evasion

In stark contrast, redistributive land reforms proved an abject structural failure:

- **Tenancy Security Laws:** Enacted to provide legal security of tenure and regulate exorbitant crop-share rents; however, rural landlords routinely evicted tenants through coercion, falsely registering them as day-laborers.
- **Land Ceiling Acts:** Laws were passed imposing legal ceilings on the maximum acreage of agricultural land an individual or family could own, with surplus land to be redistributed to landless Dalits and tribals.
- **Subversion Through Loopholes:** Wealthy landlords exploited legal loopholes, registering surplus lands under fictitious names of relatives, domestic servants, and even pet animals (**benami transfers**), or divorcing spouses on paper to retain vast plantations. Consequently, genuine land redistribution remained negligible across most states (with the prominent exceptions of **Jammu & Kashmir** and later **Kerala** and **West Bengal** under communist rule).

5. The Food Crisis of the 1960s & The Green Revolution

In the mid-1960s, agricultural stagnation, two consecutive severe droughts, and the financial toll of two wars pushed India to the brink of mass famine:

The Bihar Famine and PL-480 Humiliation

- **The Crisis (1965–1967):** Food grain production plummeted from 89 million tonnes in 1964–65 to 72 million tonnes in 1965–66. Severe famine gripped the state of **Bihar**, where malnutrition, food riots, and starvation deaths were rampant.
- **Zoning Policies:** State governments erected trade barriers ("zoning"), prohibiting the interstate movement of food grains, worsening regional shortages.
- **The PL-480 "Ship-to-Mouth" Existence:** India became desperately dependent on emergency food aid from the United States under **Public Law 480 (PL-480)**. US President Lyndon B. Johnson used food shipments as political leverage, releasing grain on a month-to-month basis ("ship-to-mouth existence") to force India to alter its agricultural policies and soften its criticism of the US war in Vietnam.

The Green Revolution: Strategy and Scientific Breakthrough

Determined to achieve food sovereignty and escape foreign geopolitical blackmail, the Indian government under Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and Agriculture Minister C. Subramaniam revolutionized agricultural policy:

- **The Paradigm Shift:** Abandoned the earlier policy of supporting impoverished, rain-fed agricultural regions. Instead, the government decided to channel massive state subsidies, technology, and fertilizers into **already prosperous, irrigated regions** possessing enterprising farmers (**"betting on the strong"**).
- **Scientific Pioneers:** Led by agricultural scientist **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan**, who adapted Nobel laureate **Norman Borlaug's** high-yielding semi-dwarf Mexican wheat strains for Indian soil conditions.
- **Core Technology Package:** Provided farmers with High Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds, subsidized chemical fertilizers, pesticides, tubewell irrigation credit, and guaranteed price insurance through **Minimum Support Prices (MSP)** announced by the newly established **Agricultural Prices Commission (1965)** and grain procurement by the **Food Corporation of India (FCI, 1965)**.
- **The Production Miracle:** Between 1967 and 1971, wheat production doubled, transforming India from a chronic food-deficit importer into a self-sufficient nation maintaining massive national buffer food stocks.

Socio-Political Consequences of the Green Revolution

While the Green Revolution solved national food security, it generated profound social and regional cleavages:

- **Regional Disparities:** The benefits were heavily concentrated in **Punjab, Haryana, and Western Uttar Pradesh**, leaving eastern India, central drylands, and the south largely bypassed.
- **Class Polarization:** Wealthy, large landowners who possessed access to tubewell irrigation, capital, and tractors reaped astronomical profits. In contrast, marginal peasants and landless laborers were displaced by mechanization.
- **The Rise of the "Kulak" Peasantry:** Created a wealthy, politically powerful class of commercial middle-caste peasant farmers (such as Jats in Haryana and UP, and Jat Sikhs in Punjab). This agrarian capitalist class organized powerful regional farmers' unions (such as the **Bharatiya Kisan Union / BKU**) and reshaped northern Indian politics through peasant parties.

6. The White Revolution: Operation Flood & The Amul Cooperative Model

Parallel to the Green Revolution in crops, India engineered a historic transformation in dairy farming known as the **White Revolution**:

Genesis in Anand, Gujarat: Tribhuvandas Patel & Amul

- In the 1940s, dairy farmers in the Kaira (Kheda) district of Gujarat were exploited by monopoly milk contractors (Polson Dairy).
- Under the guidance of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, local leader **Tribhuvandas Patel** organized smallholder farmers into a cooperative, founding the **Kaira District Co-operative Milk**

Producers' Union in Anand in 1946, marketing milk under the iconic brand name **Amul** (Anand Milk Union Limited).

Operation Flood (1970) & Dr. Verghese Kurien

- **The "Milkman of India":** In 1965, Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri established the **National Dairy Development Board (NDDB)** at Anand, appointing visionary engineer **Dr. Verghese Kurien** as its Chairman.
- **Operation Flood:** Launched in **1970**, Operation Flood was the world's largest integrated rural dairy development program:
  - Linked millions of smallholder village milk producers directly to urban consumers through a three-tier cooperative structure (village dairy societies, district unions, and state federations).
  - Eliminated middlemen, provided cattle feed, veterinary services, and artificial insemination, and utilized innovative indigenous technology (invented by H.M. Dalaya) to manufacture skimmed milk powder and condensed milk from buffalo milk.
  - Transformed India from a milk-importing country into the **world's largest milk producer**, generating steady daily cash incomes for millions of landless rural families and women.

7. Federal Planning Architecture: The National Development Council (NDC)

To prevent centralized planning from degenerating into bureaucratic centralization, the government created an intergovernmental coordinating mechanism:

- **Establishment of the NDC (August 1952):** Set up by an executive cabinet resolution to associate state governments directly with the formulation and approval of Five-Year Plans.
- **Composition:** Chaired by the **Prime Minister**, comprising all **Union Cabinet Ministers**, the **Chief Ministers of all States and Union Territories**, and the **Members of the Planning Commission**.
- **Federal Tensions in Resource Allocation:**
  - While the Finance Commission allocated constitutional revenue shares, the Planning Commission and NDC controlled discretionary capital grants for plan projects under Article 282.
  - State governments frequently accused the central Planning Commission of acting like a "Super-Cabinet", dictating uniform, top-down development schemes that ignored regional ecological and cultural realities.

8. The 1966 Rupee Devaluation & Foreign Aid Pressures

The intersection of economic planning with external geopolitical pressures produced dramatic crises in the mid-1960s:

- **The Macroeconomic Shock:** Two wars (1962 and 1965), defense budget increases, and consecutive drought-induced food shortages depleted India's foreign exchange reserves.
- **The Devaluation (June 1966):**
  - Under intense pressure from the World Bank and the United States (which tied emergency food aid and balance-of-payments loans to economic liberalization), Prime Minister Indira Gandhi announced a dramatic **36.5% devaluation of the Indian rupee** on 6 June 1966.
  - The exchange rate rose abruptly from **Rs 4.76 to Rs 7.50 per US dollar**.

- **Political Repercussions:** The devaluation triggered runaway domestic inflation, price surges for imported kerosene and fertilizers, and fierce political outrage. Opposition parties condemned the devaluation as a humiliating surrender of Indian economic sovereignty to Western financial imperialism, pushing Indira Gandhi to adopt a radical, left-wing populist economic posture.

9. The Bank Nationalisation of 1969 & Social Control of Capital

Frustrated by the reluctance of private commercial banks to finance small farmers and cottage industries, Indira Gandhi executed the most radical structural economic reform of the post-independence era:

- **The Predicament of Private Banking:** By the late 1960s, private commercial banks concentrated credit exclusively in the hands of large urban industrial houses and corporate dynasties, completely neglecting agricultural credit, rural electrification, and small enterprises.
- **The Historic Ordinance (19 July 1969):** Prime Minister Indira Gandhi promulgated the Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Ordinance, nationalizing **14 major private commercial banks** that held over 85% of total bank deposits in the country (including Punjab National Bank, Bank of Baroda, and Central Bank of India).
- **Strategic Objectives:** Reoriented credit toward "priority sectors" (agriculture, smallholder artisans, rural self-help credit), opened tens of thousands of rural bank branches across backward villages, and mobilized domestic savings for national plan investments.
- **Radical Extensions:** Bank nationalization was followed by the nationalization of general insurance in 1972 and the wholesale nationalization of coking coal mines in 1973.

10. The NITI Aayog Paradigm Shift: From Planning to Catalytic Policy

On **1 January 2015**, the Government of India formally dissolved the Planning Commission, inaugurating the **NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India) to reflect the contemporary realities of a globalized, market-oriented economy:

- **Core Philosophical Departure:**
  - **Planning Commission:** Represented a centralized, command-economy model where a central body allocated financial plan funds to state governments in a top-down, "one-size-fits-all" manner.
  - **NITI Aayog:** Operates as a strategic policy think-tank and catalyst, embodying the principle of **Cooperative Federalism** (treating states as equal national partners) and **Competitive Federalism** (benchmarking state governance through transparent indices).
- **Institutional Structure:**
  - The Prime Minister serves as the **Chairperson**.
  - **The Governing Council:** Comprises the Prime Minister, Chief Ministers of all States, and Lieutenant Governors of Union Territories.
  - Daily operations are spearheaded by a distinguished **Vice Chairperson** and a **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**.
- **Key Functions:** Focuses on formulating long-term strategic frameworks (15-year Vision, 7-year Strategy, and 3-year Action Agenda), fostering innovation, and tracking performance indices (such as the SDG India Index, Multidimensional Poverty Index, and State Health Index). NITI Aayog does not possess the power to allocate central financial funds to states; that fiscal power was entirely transferred to the statutory **Finance Commission**.

11. The Industrial Policy Resolutions: 1948 & 1956

The legal architecture governing the division of economic spheres between the public and private sectors was codified in two landmark policy declarations:

- **Industrial Policy Resolution of 1948:** First post-independence policy statement, delineating a fourfold division of industry and establishing state monopolies in atomic energy, defense armaments, and railways.
- **Industrial Policy Resolution of 1956 (The Economic Constitution):**
  - Adopted following the 1955 Avadi socialist consensus, providing the comprehensive regulatory framework for the Second Five-Year Plan.
  - Divided all industries into three rigid categories:
    - **Schedule A (17 Industries):** Exclusively reserved for state ownership (arms, atomic energy, iron and steel, heavy electricals, coal, mineral oils, aircraft, railways).
    - **Schedule B (12 Industries):** Progressively state-owned, with private enterprise acting as a supplementary junior partner (aluminum, machine tools, basic chemicals, road transport).
    - **Schedule C:** Left open to private sector enterprise, but subject to stringent state industrial licensing, price controls, and import permits.

12. "Temples of Modern India": Nehru's Secular Industrial Modernity

Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru famously referred to massive hydroelectric dams, power stations, and public steel plants as the **"Temples of Modern India"**:

- **Symbolism of National Rebirth:** Nehru believed that large engineering works—such as the Bhakra Nangal Dam, the Trombay atomic reactor, and the Bhilai steel complex—embodied the secular, scientific triumph of human reason and national unity over medieval religious superstition.
- **The Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs):** Enterprises such as the Steel Authority of India (SAIL), Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL), and Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) were conceived not merely as commercial corporations, but as engines of regional development, employment creation, and strategic self-reliance.

Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — Politics of Planned Development Summary Mindmap: Complete structural map of the Bombay Plan, First vs Second FYP, public vs private debates, land reforms, Green Revolution, and Operation Flood.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **Bombay Plan (1944):** Signed by industrial tycoons demanding state investment in heavy industrial infrastructure.
- **Planning Commission:** Formed **March 1950** via Cabinet Resolution; replaced **1 January 2015** by **NITI Aayog**.
- **First FYP (1951–56):** Architect: **K.N. Raj**; prioritized **Agriculture & Dams** (Bhakra Nangal); **"Hasten slowly"**.
- **Second FYP (1956–61):** Architect: **P.C. Mahalanobis**; prioritized **Heavy Industry** (Bhilai, Rourkela, Durgapur steel plants).
- **Plan Holidays (1966–1969):** Three annual plans following the 1962/1965 wars and severe droughts.
- **J.C. Kumarappa:** Gandhian economist; authored **Economy of Permanence**; championed village cottage industries.
- **Chaudhary Charan Singh:** Championed agrarian peasantry against urban heavy industrial planning bias.
- **PL-480:** US food aid program utilized during the 1965–67 Bihar famine ("ship-to-mouth existence").
- **Green Revolution Architect: Dr. M.S. Swaminathan**; Norman Borlaug's dwarf wheat; Punjab, Haryana, Western UP.
- **White Revolution (Operation Flood, 1970): Dr. Verghese Kurien**; NDDB; Amul cooperative dairy model in Anand, Gujarat.

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — POLITICS OF PLANNED DEVELOPMENT

▸**Planning Evolution:** Bombay Plan (1944) → Planning Commission (March 1950, extra-constitutional) → NITI Aayog (1 Jan 2015). ▸**First vs Second FYP:**

- First (1951–56): K.N. Raj → Agriculture & Irrigation (Bhakra Nangal) → "Hasten slowly".
- Second (1956–61): P.C. Mahalanobis → Heavy Industry (Bhilai, Rourkela, Durgapur steel) → High tariffs.
- Plan Holidays: 1966–1969 (3 annual plans).

▸**Major Developmental Controversies:**

- **Agri vs Industry:** Charan Singh (peasant advocacy) vs Mahalanobis; J.C. Kumarappa (Economy of Permanence, Gandhian cottage industry).
- **Public vs Private:** Mixed economy; Left critiqued corporate subsidies; Right (Swatantra) critiqued License-Permit Raj.

▸**Land Reforms Fate:** Zamindari Abolition = Successful → Land Ceilings & Tenancy Security = Subverted by benami transfers. ▸**Agricultural Revolutions:**

- **Green Revolution:** 1960s Bihar famine & PL-480 → M.S. Swaminathan → HYV seeds, fertilizers, tubewells, MSP → Concentrated in Punjab, Haryana, Western UP → Created 'kulak' middle-peasant lobby.
- **White Revolution (1970):** Operation Flood → Dr. Verghese Kurien → NDDB → Amul cooperative model in Anand.

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Trap 1 (Bombay Plan Signatories):** The Bombay Plan was NOT a socialist manifesto; it was drafted by **leading private industrialists** in 1944.
2. **Trap 2 (First vs Second Plan Architects):** First Plan was drafted by **K.N. Raj**; Second Plan was drafted by **P.C. Mahalanobis**. Do not swap them!
3. **Trap 3 (Planning Commission Legal Status):** The Planning Commission was NOT established by Parliament or the Constitution; it was created by an **executive cabinet resolution** in March 1950.
4. **Trap 4 (Economy of Permanence Author):** 'Economy of Permanence' was authored by Gandhian economist **J.C. Kumarappa**, NOT Mahatma Gandhi or E.M.S. Namboodiripad.
5. **Trap 5 (Land Reform Success vs Failure):** Zamindari abolition was **largely successful**; land ceiling and tenancy redistribution laws were **largely subverted and failed**.
6. **Trap 6 (Green Revolution Geographical Focus):** Green Revolution was NOT nationwide; it was heavily concentrated in **Punjab, Haryana, and Western Uttar Pradesh**.
7. **Trap 7 (Operation Flood Commodity):** Operation Flood is the code name for the **White Revolution (Dairy/Milk)**, NOT water irrigation or flood management!

Exam-Style Practice Questions & Detailed Solutions

Part 1: Bombay Plan, Planning Commission & Plan Architects (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. In 1944, a prominent group of leading Indian industrialists gathered in Bombay to draft a joint proposal for economic development, famously known as the:

(A) The People's Plan (B) The Bombay Plan
(C) The Gandhian Plan (D) The National Development Charter

Sol. Q1. The Bombay Plan (1944):

- In **1944**, prominent industrialists (including J.R.D. Tata and G.D. Birla) drafted the **Bombay Plan**, demanding that the state make large public capital investments in heavy industry.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. The Planning Commission of India was established in March 1950 through which institutional mechanism?

(A) A constitutional amendment passed under Article 368 (B) An Act of Parliament passed in the provisional legislature
(C) An executive resolution passed by the Union Cabinet (D) A presidential ordinance under Article 123

Sol. Q2. Establishment of the Planning Commission:

- The Planning Commission was an extra-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body established in **March 1950** via an **executive resolution of the Union Cabinet**.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. On 1 January 2015, which newly constituted think tank officially replaced the 65-year-old Planning Commission of India?

(A) NITI Aayog (B) National Development Council
(C) Economic Advisory Council to the PM (D) National Statistical Commission

Sol. Q3. Creation of NITI Aayog:

- On **1 January 2015**, the Government of India replaced the Planning Commission with **NITI Aayog** (National Institution for Transforming India) to promote cooperative federalism.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. The First Five-Year Plan (1951–1956), which prioritized agriculture, irrigation, and power projects, was drafted under the intellectual leadership of young economist:

(A) P.C. Mahalanobis (B) Sukhamoy Chakravarty
(C) Amartya Sen (D) K.N. Raj

Sol. Q4. Architect of the First Five-Year Plan:

- Young economist **K.N. Raj** played the leading intellectual role in drafting the First Five-Year Plan, urging that India must "hasten slowly" and prioritize agrarian investment.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q5. The Second Five-Year Plan (1956–1961), which shifted national priority toward rapid heavy industrialization and capital goods, was authored by:

(A) J.C. Kumarappa (B) P.C. Mahalanobis
(C) K.N. Raj (D) Chaudhary Charan Singh

Sol. Q5. Architect of the Second Five-Year Plan:

- **Prof. P.C. Mahalanobis**, founder of the Indian Statistical Institute, authored the Second Five-Year Plan, championing heavy industrialization and domestic capital-goods production.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 2: Gandhian Economics, Agrarian Debates & Food Crisis (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. Which economist proposed an alternative Gandhian framework of rural decentralization titled 'Economy of Permanence', emphasizing village cottage industries?

(A) J.C. Kumarappa (B) D.R. Gadgil
(C) V.K.R.V. Rao (D) P.C. Joshi

Sol. Q6. Economy of Permanence:

- Gandhian economist **J.C. Kumarappa** authored **Economy of Permanence**, presenting an alternative developmental vision centered on village self-reliance and cottage industries.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. Which veteran political leader resigned from the Congress to champion peasant agricultural interests against heavy industrial urban bias, later founding the Bharatiya Kranti Dal (BKD)?

(A) Morarji Desai (B) Chaudhary Charan Singh
(C) Jagjivan Ram (D) Devraj Urs

Sol. Q7. Chaudhary Charan Singh's Agrarian Stand:

- **Chaudhary Charan Singh** forcefully argued that planning had an urban-industrial bias, advocating that agriculture and peasant welfare receive primary national investment.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. During the acute food crisis of the mid-1960s, India was forced to rely heavily on subsidized wheat imports from the United States under which legislation?

(A) The Marshall Plan (B) The Lend-Lease Act
(C) Public Law 480 (PL-480) (D) The Food for Freedom Charter

Sol. Q8. US PL-480 Food Imports:

- During the mid-1960s food shortages and Bihar famine, India survived through emergency imports of American wheat under **Public Law 480 (PL-480)**.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q9. The Green Revolution in India, which introduced High Yielding Varieties (HYV) of wheat and rice along with chemical fertilizers, was primarily spearheaded by:

(A) Dr. M.S. Swaminathan (B) Dr. Verghese Kurien
(C) Dr. Homi J. Bhabha (D) Dr. Norman Borlaug

Sol. Q9. Pioneers of the Green Revolution:

- Agricultural scientist **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** spearheaded the Green Revolution in India, adapting Norman Borlaug's dwarf wheat strains to achieve national food self-sufficiency.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q10. Which three Indian states benefited most dramatically from the initial phase of the Green Revolution due to established irrigation infrastructure?

(A) Bihar, Odisha, and West Bengal (B) Punjab, Haryana, and Western Uttar Pradesh
(C) Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Rajasthan (D) Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Karnataka

Sol. Q10. Geographical Core of the Green Revolution:

- The Green Revolution was heavily concentrated in **Punjab, Haryana, and Western Uttar Pradesh**, where tube-well irrigation and fertile canal networks were readily available.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 3: Operation Flood, Bhakra Dam, Plan Holidays & Kulaks (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. The 'White Revolution' in India, also known as 'Operation Flood', was launched in 1970 under the leadership of which renowned visionary?

(A) Dr. M.S. Swaminathan
(B) Chandi Prasad Bhatt
(C) Dr. Verghese Kurien
(D) Sunderlal Bahuguna

Sol. Q11. Architect of Operation Flood:

- **Dr. Verghese Kurien** ("Milkman of India") led Operation Flood from Anand, Gujarat, organizing dairy farmers into cooperatives under the NDDB and creating Amul.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q12. In the institutional architecture of India's planned development, the First Five-Year Plan famously allocated enormous state capital to which monumental multipurpose dam project?

(A) The Tehri Dam
(B) The Sardar Sarovar Dam
(C) The Nagarjuna Sagar Dam
(D) The Bhakra Nangal Dam

Sol. Q12. Bhakra Nangal Dam in First Plan:

- The First Five-Year Plan allocated massive public investment to large multipurpose irrigation and hydro projects, most notably the **Bhakra Nangal Dam** across the Sutlej River.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q13. Following the economic strains of the 1962 China War, 1965 Pakistan War, and severe droughts, the Government of India declared three annual:

(A) Plan Holidays (1966–1969)
(B) National Fiscal Emergencies
(C) Moratoriums on Agricultural Credit
(D) Industrial Freeze Periods

Sol. Q13. The Plan Holidays (1966–1969):

- Severe droughts, food shortages, currency devaluation, and two wars forced the government to suspend Five-Year Plans, implementing three annual plans known as **Plan Holidays (1966–1969)**.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q14. Among the various land reform measures initiated in independent India, which policy proved to be the most successfully implemented nationwide?

(A) Imposition of agricultural land ceilings
(B) Consolidation of fragmented land holdings
(C) Abolition of the colonial Zamindari system
(D) Redistribution of surplus land to landless agricultural labor

Sol. Q14. Success of Zamindari Abolition:

- The legal **abolition of the Zamindari system** was the most successful land reform, dismantling feudal estates and bringing millions of cultivators into direct relationship with the state.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q15. The primary socio-political consequence of the Green Revolution in rural northern India was:

(A) The complete eradication of landlessness across all states
(B) The immediate collapse of private industrial corporations
(C) The elimination of commercial cash crop agriculture
(D) The rise of a prosperous, politically assertive middle-peasant class ('kulaks')

Sol. Q15. Rise of the Kulak Peasantry:

- The Green Revolution enriched medium and large farmers in the north, creating an influential class of prosperous middle-caste peasants (**"kulaks"**) who emerged as powerful political actors.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**